

Advertising Psychology Checklist

BONUS CONTENT



Customer Research

/ 3 pts

- ☐ **Hopes/Pains/Barriers:** First and foremost, you need to understand who your users are. Knowing your customers inside-out will sell, not your instincts. Now, you don't need to know if your ideal customer is a 35-year-old lady. You need to know what she hopes to accomplish, her biggest pain point, and why she hasn't reached her goal yet. Demographics are not as crucial as customer emotions.
- ☐ **Talk to real people:** Surveys are great when you want to refine your data and have already done a lot of qualitative research. But the reality is that talking to 5 different people in real life will give you more insights than looking at numbers on a spreadsheet.
- ☐ **Language:** When talking to real people, pay attention to their words. How do they talk about your product, and what type of vocabulary they use when talking about their problems. Language is really important when you want to make relatable ads that capture attention. Accuracy is key.



Ad Creation Tips

/ 7 pts

- ☐ **Context (ad placement):** A great ad on one platform will not necessarily perform well on another platform. Context is everything, just like we saw in this case study (Von Restorff Effect). The best way to stand out is to get what other types of content around your ad will look like. Your ad doesn't need to look like an ad. It just needs to convey a clear message.
- ☐ **The big idea:** Your ad needs to have one big idea. What are you trying to say, debunk, or question with your message? Without a big statement, most people will ignore the overall message. There are no dull products, just boring copywriters.
- ☐ **Promise real value:** People buy things whose advertising promises them value for beauty, money, nutrition, relief from suffering, and social status. Where does your product land here? And how can you make sure the message gives a clear portrait of how your product can help people get these things.
- ☐ **Tell stories:** Everything starts with a story. We're hard-wired to make sense of the world in

stories, and that's why they can change realities and beliefs. Stories don't have to be complex and detailed. They have to be graphic and emotional.

- ☐ **Be informative:** The best way to sell a product to someone is to explain in a clear, honest, and informative way what your product can do for them. What's the benefit? Be clear, not clever.
- ☐ **Be newsworthy:** When your product has something new to say that the world hasn't seen yet, then your ad will see a 22% lift in recall from people. People will start ignoring your ads if you're always selling the same old thing. This is a good reminder that pushing your product boundaries can be rewarding. Try to innovate as much as you can.
- ☐ **Make the product the hero:** Whenever you have a chance to display how your product works, you should do it. People want to see the end result of using your product. Also, before and after shots are always a winner.



Things To Avoid

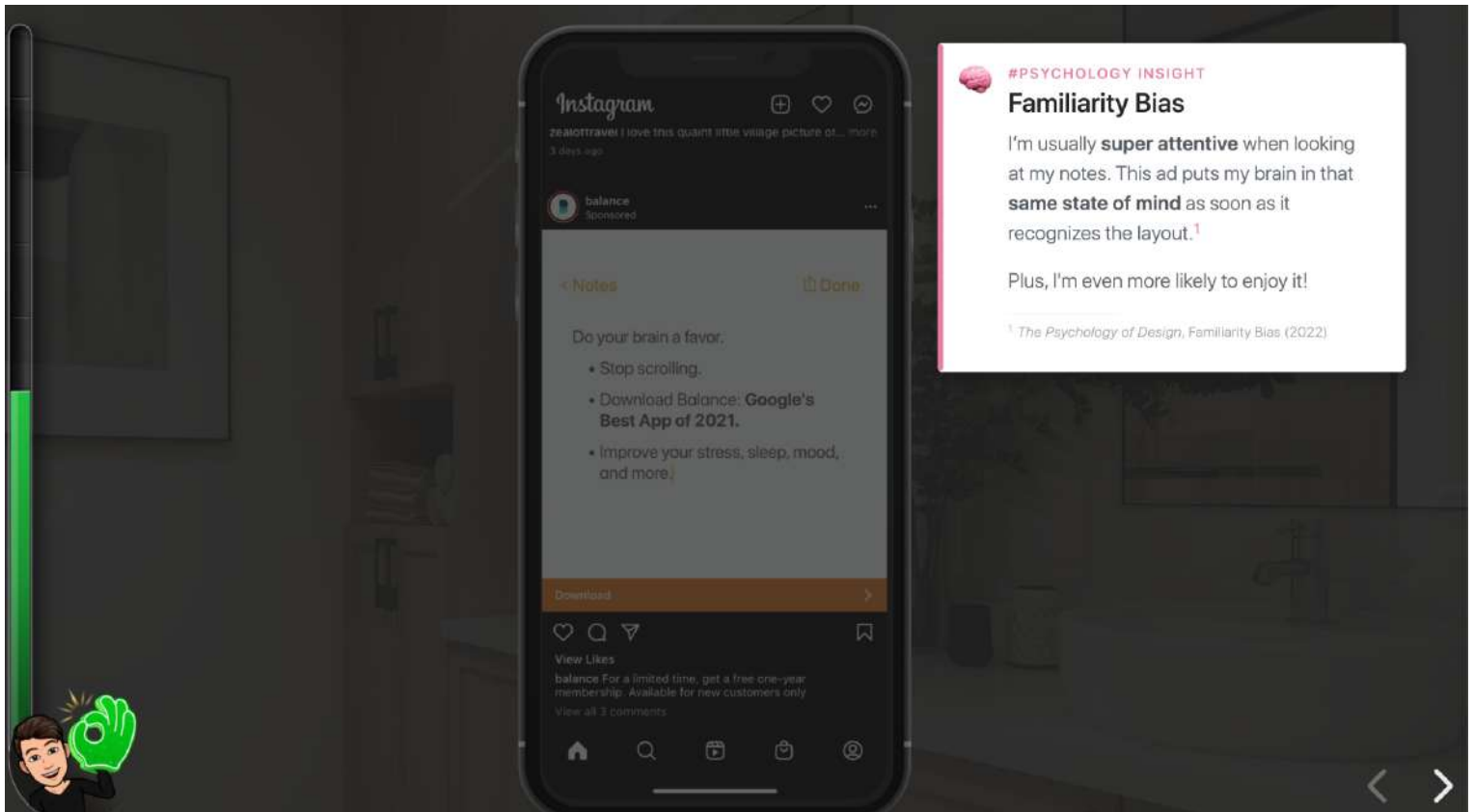
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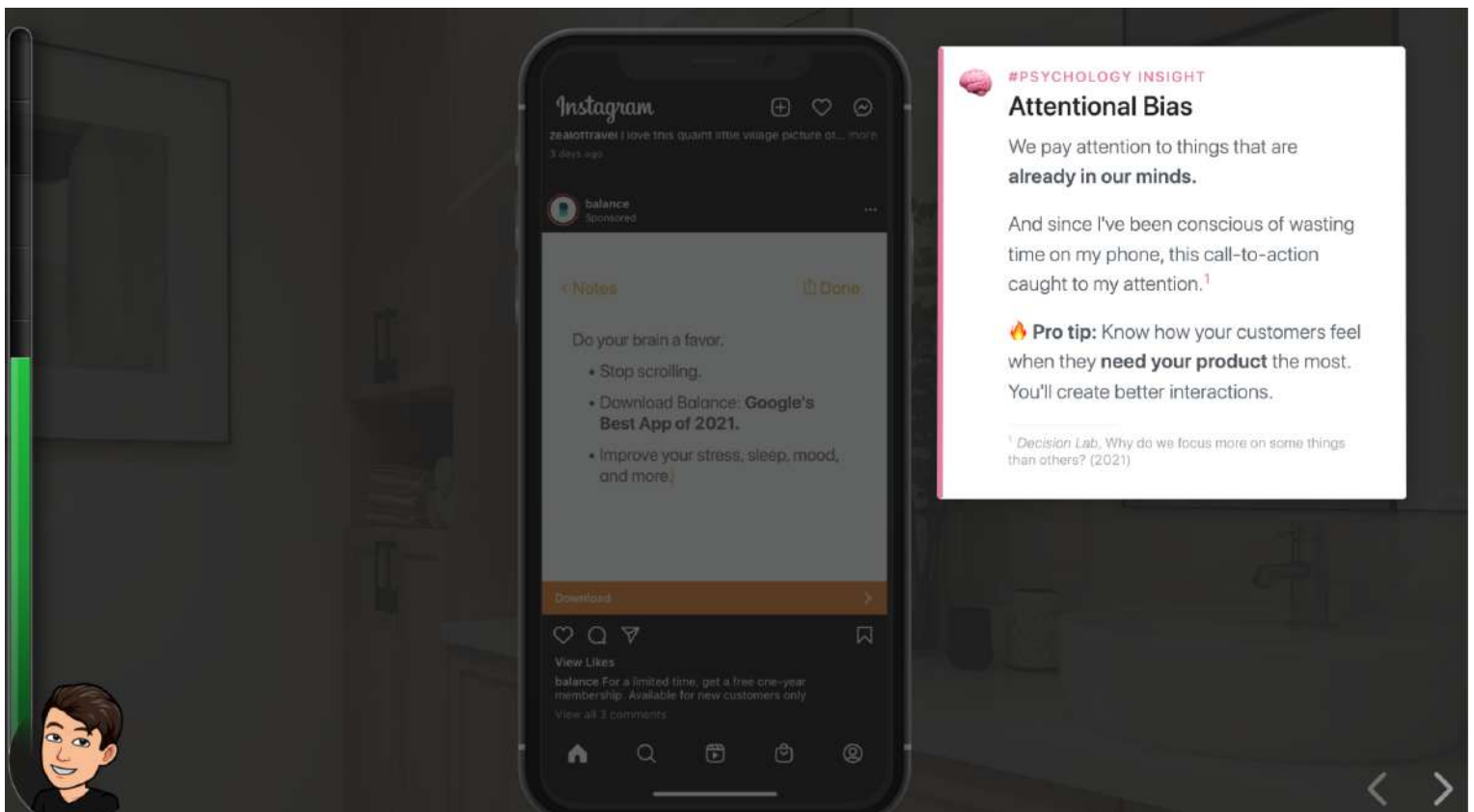
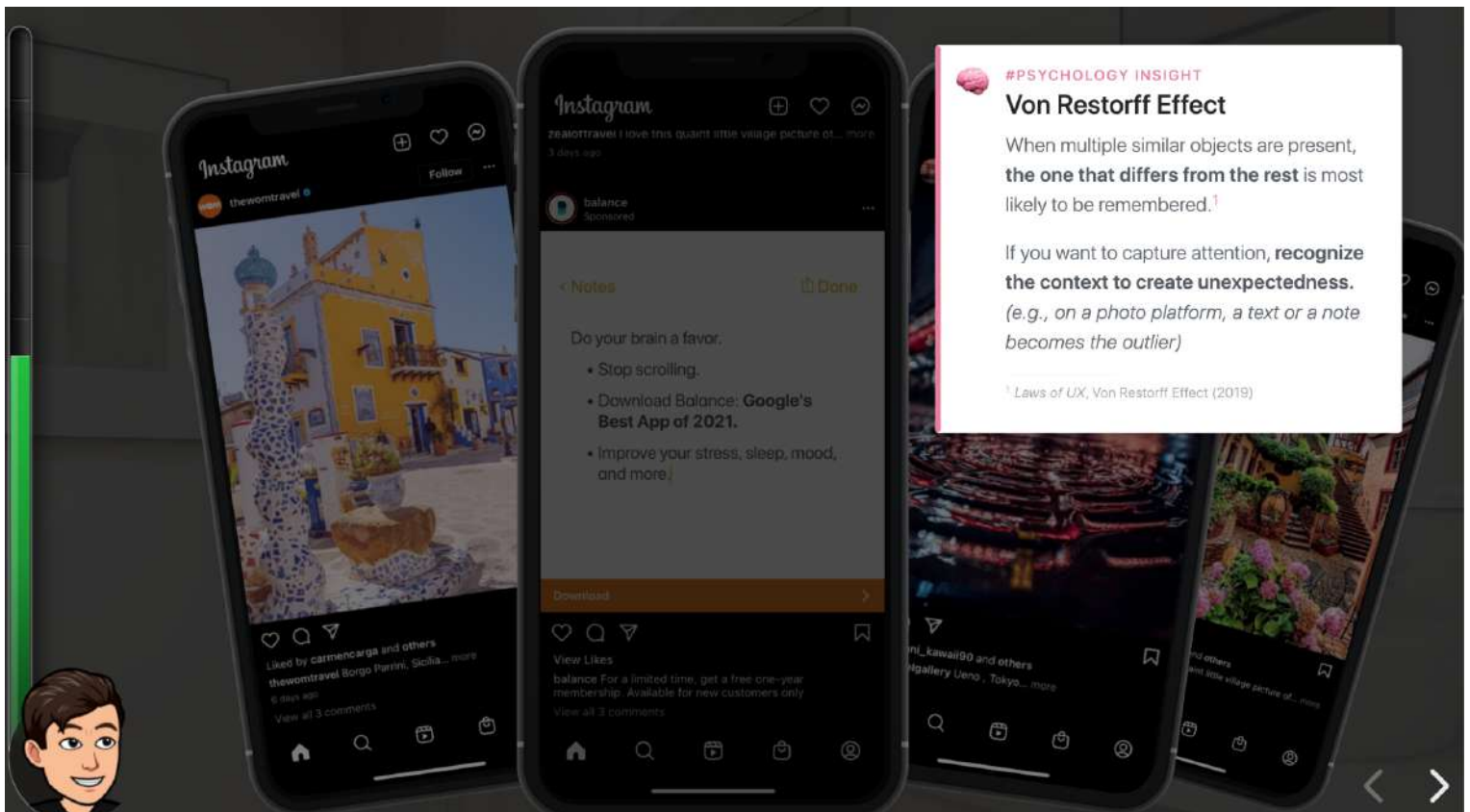
- ☐ **Avoid analogies:** People get confused with analogies, it's too hard to process so they skip it. We have too much information to filter through, and if you're too clever, people will look past it.
- ☐ **Avoid superlatives:** People have become skeptical about something being the "best". (rightly!) All products have their flaws. You don't have to highlight the flaws, but make sure you stay grounded and authentic. Nobody is perfect, and that's okay.
- ☐ **Avoid talking about your competition:** People get confused when you introduce other brand names in your ads. They tend to recall your competitors as much as your own brand, and that's not always good for you. Focus on what your product can do, and you'll be better off!
- ☐ **Avoid testimonials that are "too good":** If testimonials or quotes are too good, people will believe they're fake (and not make a decision). The best testimonials are the ones that also give you some criticism.
- ☐ **Avoid celebrities:** Surprisingly, people tend to remember celebrities more than the actual product. While celebrities can be great ambassadors, make sure they're not stealing the show! (Fun fact: while I'm writing this, I just remembered Ryan Reynolds recently did a really funny ad with a soccer team, and I can't recall the product 😅)

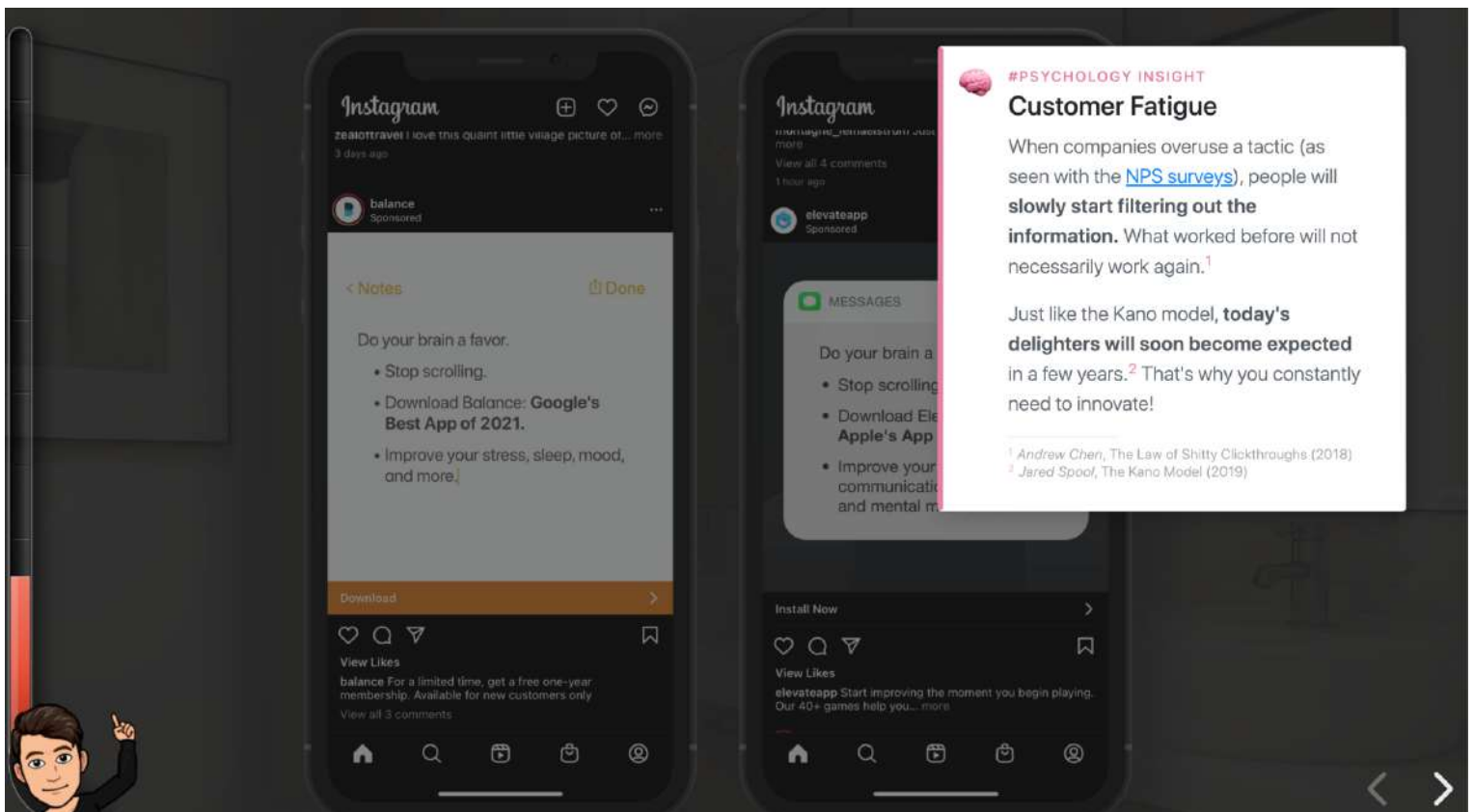
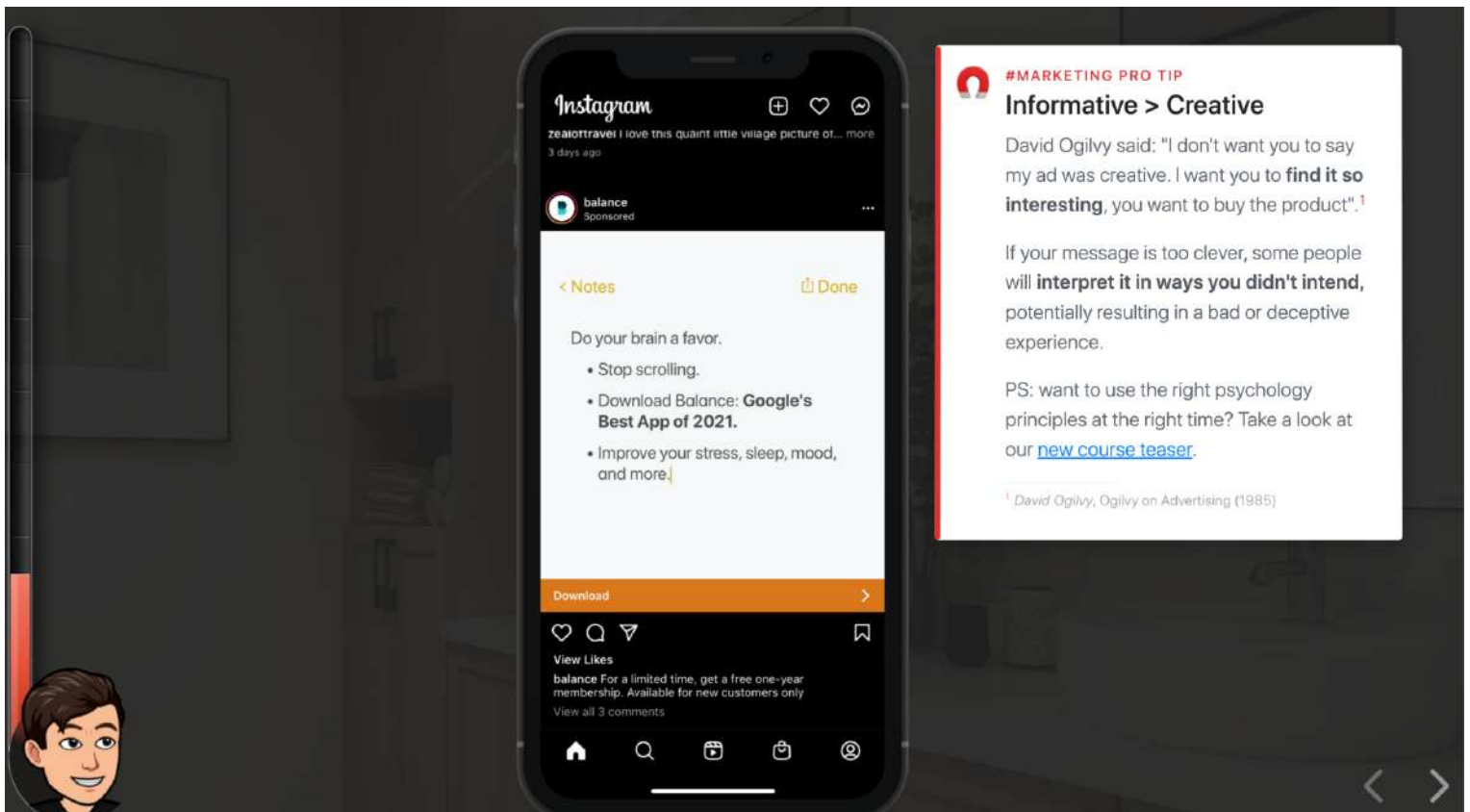


Case Study Insights Summary

Here are all the psychology and user experience insights covered in the case study:









Additional Resources



Product Psychology Course.

If you want to learn how to use psychology to create better experiences for your customers, check out our course:

<https://growth.design/course>



Cognitive Biases Cheatsheet.

100+ cognitive biases and design principles that affect your product experiences. Tons of product examples, tips and checklists to improve your user experience:

<https://growth.design/psychology>

—Dan Benoni & Louis-Xavier Lavallée